

WF

CHRISTMAS 2026 EDITION

WILEY FOX TRAVEL
FAMILIES AND SOLO TRAVELLERS

THE WILEY FOX GUIDE TO

Munich

For families & solo travellers

4

WILEY FOX RATING • LOW

OUT OF 5 • POLICE DATA JAN 2025 TO DEC 2025

CREATOR FEELING 4/5 • SAFE AND CALM - BUT VERY CROWDED AT MARIENPLATZ

20 Nov-24 Dec

MARIENPLATZ CHRISTKINDLMARKT 2026

Mon-Sat 10:00-21:00, Sun to 20:00, 24 Dec to 14:00; closed Sun 22 Nov (organiser, Sept 2026).

80%

MARIENPLATZ STALLS TAKING CARDS

The organiser's figure, some with a €1-10 minimum. Creators still found many stalls cash only, so carry both.

83

CREATORS · 107 VIDEOS

Paraphrased and credited, cross-checked with police figures.

Munich is a big city with a compact, walkable centre. From the Hauptbahnhof it's a 15-minute walk through the pedestrian zone past Karlsplatz (Stachus) to Marienplatz, the main square, with the Frauenkirche, the Viktualienmarkt food market and the Residenz palace all close by. The Englischer Garten, one of the world's biggest city parks, starts just north of the old town. Creators suggest two to three days, plus a day trip if you can.

At Christmas the whole old town becomes one long market, from Karlsplatz to Marienplatz and the Rindermarkt, and there are a dozen more around it: a medieval market, a fairy-tale village in the Residenz courtyard for small children, a woodland market by the Chinese Tower, the pink LGBTQ+ market and the Tollwood winter festival on the Oktoberfest grounds. For families there are puppet shows, curling, an ice rink at Karlsplatz and the Deutsches Museum for wet days.

For solo travellers Munich is the easiest big city in Germany: police figures are the lowest of the big cities and creators felt safe everywhere, including alone at night. The things to plan for are crowds at Marienplatz (worst on Saturdays and at the noon Glockenspiel), real cold, early darkness, and the scruffier streets around the Hauptbahnhof, where many of the cheaper hotels are.

WF

Germany doesn't publish street-level crime data, so before you book, check your hotel's street against the map in this guide and any community reports on Wiley Fox. Near the Hauptbahnhof, the north side (towards Karlstraße) is quieter than the streets south of the station.

Fast facts

CURRENCY Euro (EUR) - most Marienplatz stalls now take cards, but many smaller stalls, bakeries and toilets want cash

LANGUAGE German - English is widely spoken in the centre

TIME ZONE Central European Time (UTC+1) - one hour ahead of the UK

PLUG Type C and F, 230V - UK plugs need an adaptor

EMERGENCY 110 police · 112 fire & ambulance · 116 117 out-of-hours doctor

ENTRY UK passport must be under 10 years old on arrival and valid 3+ months after you leave the Schengen area; visa-free for up to 90 days in any 180 (gov.uk, Sept 2026)

TIPPING About 5-10%, or round up - tell the server the total you want to pay

BEST TIME Late November to 23 December for the markets (weekday daytimes are calmest); spring and early autumn outside Oktoberfest for sightseeing

THE FESTIVE SEASON

Christmas in Munich

Munich's Christmas market season is one of Germany's biggest: the old Christkindlmarkt on Marienplatz, traced back to 1642, spreads down the pedestrian zone, and a dozen themed markets surround it - medieval, fairy-tale, woodland, pink and the Tollwood winter festival. In 2026 Marienplatz runs from 20 November to 24 December. It is very crowded at weekends, but Munich has the lowest recorded crime of Germany's big cities, and police run uniformed and plain-clothes patrols and cameras across the markets.

Christmas markets



Photo: Usien · CC BY-SA 3.0

Münchner Christkindlmarkt

MARIENPLATZ AND THE PEDESTRIAN ZONE • 20 NOV - 24 DEC 2026 • MON-SAT 10:00-21:00, SUN 10:00-20:00, 24 DEC 10:00-14:00 • CLOSED 22 NOV • GREAT FOR KIDS

The original: over 130 stalls in front of the Neues Rathaus under a 25-30 m tree, running on through the pedestrian streets. Stalls sell ornaments, Lebkuchen and stollen; creators liked the bratwurst, Flammfachs (flame-grilled salmon in a roll, €9 in 2024 - long queue), apple fritters and Quarkbällchen. Advent music plays from the Rathaus balcony most evenings from 17:15. Several creators found it traditional rather than special, and pricier than a few streets away.

Crowds: The busiest market in the city - 'made Oktoberfest look like a walk in the park' on a Saturday. Fairly packed an hour after opening even on a Tuesday. Go early afternoon on a weekday; Rindermarkt and the Viktualienmarkt give breathing room.

Via [Chris and Sara](#), [Life With Rachel and Christian](#), [Sophie Nadeau](#), [Here's Good](#), [Boozing Abroad](#) | [Sam and Chris](#), [Andrew & Kait](#), [Adventures of A+K](#), [Near From Home](#) | [Slow Travel Germany](#), [WalkingAround Caro](#), [East-West Wander](#)

Free entry · Glühwein €4-7.50 + €5 mug deposit (2025)

DETAILS



Photo: Richard Huber · [CC BY-SA 3.0](#)



Krippermarkt & Rindermarkt

BY ALTER PETER AND THE RINDERMARKT · 20 NOV - 24 DEC 2026 (WITH THE MAIN MARKET) · GREAT FOR KIDS

A street of stalls selling Bavarian nativity scenes and figures, from affordable to very expensive, next to a 12 m Christmas windmill. The Rindermarkt stalls, a couple of minutes from Marienplatz, are built like little houses around a giant pyramid, with Kirschwein in boot-shaped mugs and a Krampus run in early December.

Crowds: Noticeably quieter than Marienplatz - a good after-work spot.

Via [Chris and Sara](#), [Any Way You Travel](#), [Sophie Nadeau](#), [WalkingAround Caro](#), [Mathers On The Map](#), [Fatih Anlatiyor](#)

Free entry

DETAILS



Photo: Burkhard Mücke · [CC BY-SA 4.0](#)



Weihnachtsdorf im Kaiserhof der Residenz

RESIDENZ COURTYARD, OFF ODEONSPLATZ · 16 NOV - 22 DEC 2026 · DAILY 11:00-21:00 (22 DEC TO 20:00) · CLOSED 22 NOV · GREAT FOR KIDS

The small-children's favourite: a Christmas village in the palace courtyard with a free fairy-tale forest, Hansel-and-Gretel scenes, animatronic displays and a corner where puppets tell Christmas stories. Good food, Käsespätzle and Kinderpunsch. Glühwein was €10 including a €5 mug deposit in 2025.

Crowds: Calm and quiet by day with tables to sit at; packed at dinner time, and there can be a queue to get in at weekends.

Via [Andrew & Kait](#), [Chasing Charisma](#), [Fatih Anlatiyor](#), [Adventures of A+K](#), [Life With Rachel and Christian](#), [Mathers On The Map](#), [Lazy Ley Travels](#), [East-West Wander](#), [thelittlebasket](#)

Free entry · Glühwein €5 + €5 deposit (2025)

DETAILS

Medieval Christmas market (Mittelaltermarkt)

WITTELSBACHERPLATZ • 20 NOV - 23 DEC 2026 • DAILY 11:00-21:00 • CLOSED 22 NOV
• GREAT FOR KIDS



Straw floors, torches, open fires and costumed stallholders, with blacksmiths, acrobats at weekends, roast pig, flame-grilled salmon, mead and flaming Feuerzangenbowle in clay goblets. Sophie Nadeau rated it the best food of Munich's markets. Also the most expensive: goblet deposits are €10-15.

Crowds: Best after dark, when it gets busy with live music.

Via [Sophie Nadeau](#), [Boozing Abroad](#) | [Sam and Chris](#), [Chris and Sara](#), [East-West Wander](#), [Life With Rachel and Christian](#), [Ciao I'm Ciao](#), [Lazy Ley Travels](#), [Mathers On The Map](#), [Adventures of A+K](#)

Free entry · drink about €8 + €10-15 goblet deposit (2025), cash only

DETAILS

Christkindlmarkt am Chinesischen Turm

ENGLISCHER GARTEN • 19 NOV - 23 DEC 2026, WED-SUN ONLY • 11:00/11:30-20:30
• GREAT FOR KIDS

A woodland village around the wooden Chinese Tower, with a live band, good food and Eisstockschießen (Bavarian curling) that children love - and snowball fights on the meadows if it snows. Near From Home calls it probably the most kid-friendly market.

Crowds: Local and relaxed - noticeably quieter than the Residenz. A walk through the park from Universität U-Bahn.

Via [Near From Home](#) | [Slow Travel Germany](#), [Sophie Nadeau](#), [Bayern Reisetipps](#) | [Reiseeuphorie](#), [Happy to Wander \(Travel Tips & Inspo\)](#), [Adventures of A+K](#)

Free entry

DETAILS



Pink Christmas

STEPHANSPLATZ, GLOCKENBACHVIERTEL • 20 NOV - 20 DEC 2026 • MON-FRI 16:00-22:00, SAT-SUN 14:00-22:00 • GREAT FOR KIDS

Germany's first pink Christmas market (about 20 years old): pink lights, disco balls, rainbow mugs, a DJ and evening acts, and plenty of vegan food. Warm and welcoming, allies included. Some drinks raise money for the Munich AIDS charity.

Crowds: Best after dark; busier later in the evening.

Via [Sturmwaffel](#), [Fatih Anlatiyor](#), [Sophie Nadeau](#), [Happy to Wander \(Travel Tips & Inspo\)](#), [Travels of Sarah Fay](#)

Free entry · Glühwein €6 (2023)

DETAILS

Tollwood Winter Festival

THERESIENWIESE (OKTOBERFEST GROUNDS) • 24 NOV - 23 DEC 2026 • WEEKDAYS FROM 14:00, WEEKENDS FROM 11:00, TO 22:30-23:30 • GREAT FOR KIDS



A fair-trade and world-food festival in big heated tents on the Oktoberfest meadow, with art installations, live music and a circus (ticketed). Locals love it; some creators found it less Christmassy and very busy. Andrew & Kait had the best-value Glühwein of the day here. Closed 24-30 Dec.

Crowds: Can be 'exceptionally crowded' in the evening, with queues for tent shows; the covered tents are a lifesaver in rain.

Via [Andrew & Kait](#), [Sophie Nadeau](#), [East-West Wander](#), [Travels of Sarah Fay](#), [MemorySeekers](#), [Near From Home](#) | [Slow Travel Germany](#), [Life With Rachel and Christian](#)

Free entry (circus ticketed)

DETAILS

Sendlinger Tor & Schwabing

SENDLINGER TOR GATE; MÜNCHNER FREIHEIT • SENDLINGER TOR 20 NOV - 22 DEC 2026 • SCHWABING 25 NOV - 24 DEC 2026 (24 DEC TO 14:00) • GREAT FOR KIDS



Two smaller local markets. Sendlinger Tor has about 20 stalls under the old city gate - Boozing Abroad's favourite for its local feel and cheese-filled sausage, 'just okay' for Happy to Wander. Schwabing, in its 50th year, showcases local artists and craftspeople.

Crowds: Uncrowded.

Via [Boozing Abroad](#) | [Sam and Chris](#), [Happy to Wander \(Travel Tips & Inspo\)](#), [Sophie Nadeau](#), [Andrew & Kait](#), [Mathers On The Map](#)

Free entry

DETAILS

Haidhausen Christmas market

WEISSENBURGER PLATZ, HAIDHAUSEN • 2026 DATES NOT YET PUBLISHED (2025: 24 NOV - 23 DEC, 11:00-21:00) • GREAT FOR KIDS



A traditional local favourite with artisan crafts in a residential square - relaxed and family-friendly.

Crowds: Quiet.

Via [Near From Home](#) | [Slow Travel Germany](#)

Free entry

DETAILS

Lights, rinks and festive sights

Eiszauber at Karlsplatz

KARLSPLATZ (STACHUS) • WINTER SEASON - 2026 DATES NOT YET PUBLISHED • GREAT FOR KIDS



An open-air ice rink built in the summer fountain at Stachus, with Alpine-hut bars round it and skate hire. Watching the skaters with a hot drink is a good family stop.

Crowds: Busy evenings and weekends.

Via [Near From Home](#) | [Slow Travel Germany](#), [Greece and Beyond](#), [WalkingAround Caro](#), [Sophie Nadeau](#)

Price not published

DETAILS

The market from Alter Peter

MARIENPLATZ • JUST BEFORE SUNSET (ABOUT 16:20)



Climb St Peter's tower for the lit market with the Frauenkirche behind. Narrow, cold and busy - not for small children at peak times.

Crowds: Two-way stair; packed at times.

Via [thelittlebasket](#), [Here's Good](#), [Adventures of A+K](#)

€5 (2026)

DETAILS

Krampus runs

OLD TOWN • EARLY DECEMBER



Alpine Krampus clubs parade in horned demon costumes through the centre - 300+ figures from Sendlinger Straße to the Rindermarkt in 2023. A spectacle, but genuinely frightening for small children, and some runs involve whips and chasing.

Crowds: Dense along the route; Marienplatz is the main viewing spot.

Via [Bayern Reisetipps](#) | [Reiseeuphorie](#), [Near From Home](#) | [Slow Travel Germany](#), [Feli from Germany](#)

Free

DETAILS

Advent music from the Rathaus balcony

MARIENPLATZ • EVENINGS FROM 17:15 (SUN-THU, PER THE ORGANISER) • GREAT FOR KIDS



Brass and choirs from the town hall balcony over the market - a free, very Munich moment.

Crowds: The square is packed around it.

Source: Polizeipräsidium München / Stadt München

Free

DETAILS

Staying safe in the Christmas crowds

Crowds and timing

Marienplatz is shoulder to shoulder on Saturdays and in the evenings, and filled with phones at the 11:00 and 12:00 Glockenspiel. Early afternoon on a weekday is calmest; the Residenz is calm by day but packed at dinner time.

Via [Chris and Sara](#), [WalkingAround Caro](#), [Life With Rachel and Christian](#), [Mathers On The Map](#)

Pickpockets: fewer, but police still warn

Pickpocketing fell 11% in 2025 to less than half its 2016 level, and police run uniformed and plain-clothes patrols, pickpocket squads and cameras at Marienplatz and the pedestrian zone. They still say thefts happen 'again and again' in market crowds: inner pockets, bags closed and in front, extra care in queues.

Via [Deana and Phil](#)

No knives on the markets

Munich police say carrying weapons and knives is banned on Christmas markets under weapons law. A permanent knife ban also covers the Alter Botanischer Garten by the station.

Source: Polizeipräsidium München / Stadt München

Cash, cards and deposits

The Marienplatz organiser says 80% of stalls take cards, some above a €1-10 minimum, but creators found many stalls cash only, and the medieval market was cash only in 2025. Mug deposits were €5 in 2025, and €10-15 at the medieval market. Toilets are at the Rathaus Prunkhof and the Marienplatz station.

Via [Boozing Abroad](#) | [Sam and Chris](#), [East-West Wander](#), [Wolters World](#), [valeska](#)

Cold and dark

It's dark by about 4:20pm and creators saw freezing rain and heavy snow. Stalls have no heaters and few napkins - eating while you queue keeps you warm. The Residenz village and Tollwood have seating under cover.

Via [Adventures of Matt and Nat](#), [Wolters World](#), [Ciara Gan](#), [Jm Banquicio](#)

Have a lost-child plan

Before you go in, agree a meeting point everyone can find - the Fish Fountain (Fischbrunnen) on Marienplatz is the classic one. A Wiley Fox QR wristband on each child means anyone who finds them can reach you straight away.

Source: Polizeipräsidium München / Stadt München

New Year's Eve

In 2025/26 fireworks were banned from 21:00 to 02:00 in the pedestrian zone from Marienplatz to Karlsplatz and at the Viktualienmarkt, and bangers were banned all day inside the Mittlerer Ring. About 6,000 people were at Marienplatz at midnight and press reports of the police balance called the night largely peaceful. 2026/27 rules are not out yet.

Source: Polizeipräsidium München / Stadt München

In 2026 the Marienplatz market runs 20 November to 24 December (closed Sunday 22 November; 24 December until 14:00); the Residenz village runs from 16 November to 22 December, Pink Christmas to 20 December, and most others to 23 December. Only Marienplatz and Schwabing open on Christmas Eve, and

Tollwood is closed 24-30 December. Book hotels and restaurants early. Zone M day tickets rise from €10.10 to €10.80 on 1 January 2027.

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Clip a Wiley Fox QR wristband on each child. If you get separated in the Marienplatz crowd, anyone who scans it can contact you straight away - no app needed on their side.

WHAT THE DATA AND THE CREATORS SAY

*How it feels, and what the numbers show**The data*

Munich has the lowest recorded crime of Germany's big cities. Police recorded 5,798 offences per 100,000 residents in the city in 2025, down 2.7%, against 13,233 in Berlin and 10,567 in Hamburg on the police's own comparison, and the Eurostat table below puts it lowest of eight big German cities for theft and robbery. Pickpocketing fell 11% in 2025 and street robbery by more than half. Two things went the other way: violent crime reached a ten-year high (up 2%), and recorded rapes rose 23%, though police say three in four involved people who knew each other. The areas police focus on are the Hauptbahnhof and the streets south of it, the Alter Botanischer Garten and Stachus. This rating is for the city as a whole, not street by street: German police do not publish street-level crime data.

The creators

Creators consistently call Munich one of the safest big cities they have visited. Rok Goes Around says pickpocketing is much rarer than in other large European cities, Happy to Wander says you won't be in danger even near the station, and Oriana Findlay, visiting alone, found even the Hofbräuhaus female friendly. The U-Bahn and S-Bahn were described as clean and safe. The complaints are crowds - Chris and Sara said a Saturday at the Marienplatz market made Oktoberfest look like a walk in the park - fast cyclists, cold weather, and prices. A local (German Insider) and Stefano Ferro both describe the Hauptbahnhof area as the scruffiest and noisiest part of the city.

What the official figures say

Figures are from the Munich police's Sicherheitsreport 2025 (published March 2026). The headline rate is for the City of Munich; all other counts cover the whole police area (city plus Landkreis München, about 1.86 million people). No street-level data is published. From 2025 the report uses Census 2022 population figures, so older rates are not directly comparable. Pickpocketing: 1,489 cases (down 10.6%, and less than half the

2016 level), with 340 on public transport (slightly up). Street robbery: 143 (down 59%). Violent crime: 5,133 (up 2%). Recorded offences in the Alter Botanischer Garten by the station fell 66% to 436 after alcohol, cannabis and knife bans from January 2025. Police say the Hauptbahnhof, a building site until well into the 2030s with about 450,000 people a day, still sees begging, street drinking and litter, but much less than a year earlier. Rates are per resident, so visitors and commuters push them up.

5,798

RECORDED OFFENCES PER 100,000 RESIDENTS IN 2025

City of Munich, down 2.7% on 2024. Police say Munich keeps 'the top spot' for safety among comparable big cities (Sicherheitsreport 2025).

-11%

PICKPOCKETING IN 2025 (1,489 CASES)

Less than half the 2016 level. Street robbery fell 59% to 143 cases (Munich police area).

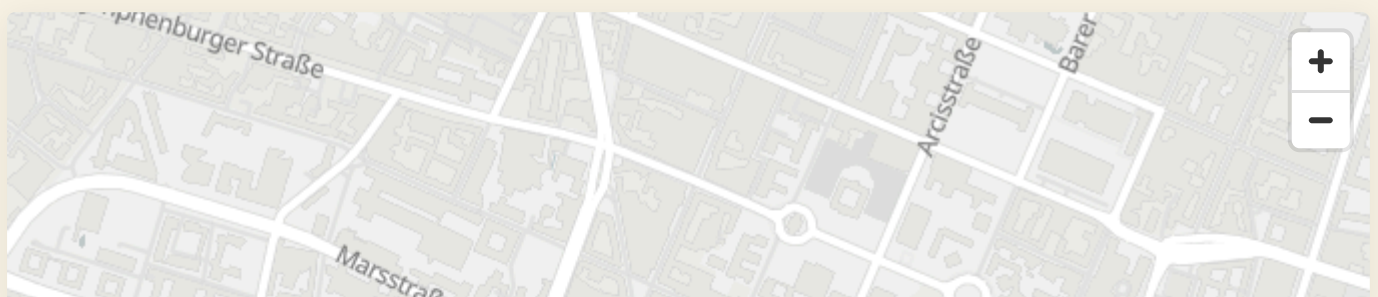
-66%

OFFENCES IN THE ALTER BOTANISCHER GARTEN

The park beside the Hauptbahnhof, after alcohol, cannabis and knife bans from January 2025: 436 offences, down from 1,284.

Map: markets, sights and places to take care

Germany doesn't publish street-level crime data, so this map shows the markets and sights in this guide and the places Munich police and the city focus on around the station.





Pins

■ Christmas market ■ Sight or base ■ Take extra care

Crime figures: Polizeipräsidium München, Sicherheitsreport 2025 · [Open the Wiley Fox map](#)

How Munich compares with other German cities

Police-recorded offences per 100,000 residents in 2024, using the same Eurostat measure for every city. Munich ranks 1 of 8 big German cities for robbery (1 = lowest). Big cities all sit above the national average because shoppers, commuters and visitors are counted as victims but not as residents.

	THEFT	ROBBERY	ASSAULT	BURGLARY
Munich	1,272	51	806	276
Nuremberg	1,701	60	889	413
Stuttgart	1,801	107	1,102	358
Hamburg	3,255	127	1,251	469
Düsseldorf	3,351	129	1,097	755
Cologne	3,462	132	1,345	806
Berlin	3,228	140	1,382	1,098
Frankfurt	2,826	170	1,256	594
Germany average	1,377	52	750	357

per 100,000 residents, 2024

Compare within Germany only. Countries record assault and burglary differently, so a lower number in another country does not mean it is safer. Source: [Eurostat, police-recorded offences by NUTS 3 region \(crim_gen_reg\), 2024](#)

Areas to take extra care

None of these are no-go areas. Know the pattern, and plan your timing and your route home.

● Hauptbahnhof & the southern Bahnhofsviertel

TAKE MOST CARE: EVENINGS AND NIGHT

Munich's main station is a building site until well into the 2030s, with about 450,000 people passing through a day. Police say begging, street drinking, rough sleeping and litter are much less common than a year earlier, and their focus has moved to the streets south of the station (between Bayerstraße, Landwehrstraße and Sonnenstraße) and Nußbaumpark, where they now have camera towers. Drinking alcohol on the street around the station is banned. Creators found it scruffy rather than dangerous. Keep an eye on bags in the concourse, and use the main roads at night.

Via [Stefano Ferro, German Insider](#), [Happy to Wander \(Travel Tips & Inspo\)](#)

● Alter Botanischer Garten

TAKE MOST CARE: AFTER DARK

The small park between the station and Stachus was Munich's biggest trouble spot: 1,284 offences in 2024. After alcohol, cannabis, weapon and knife bans, better lighting and cameras from January 2025, offences fell 66% to 436. It's still not a shortcut to take late at night - walk round via Karlsplatz. Kai Travel found a lot of litter around the fountain.

Via [Kai Travel](#)

● Karlsplatz (Stachus)

TAKE MOST CARE: LATE EVENING

The big square at the start of the pedestrian zone, home to the Eiszauber ice rink at Christmas. Police had complaints about loud groups of young people in 2024 and 2025 and now have a mobile camera tower as well as the fixed camera. Busy and well lit - just keep valuables close.

Via [Greece and Beyond](#), [Near From Home](#) | [Slow Travel Germany](#)

● Marienplatz at the Glockenspiel and on Saturdays

TAKE MOST CARE: 11:00 AND 12:00 DAILY, AND SATURDAY AFTERNOONS AND EVENINGS

The square fills with a wall of phones for the Glockenspiel, and on December Saturdays the market is shoulder to shoulder. Police warn of pickpockets in crowds and queues, and have uniformed and plain-clothes patrols and cameras at Marienplatz and the pedestrian zone. Go early on a weekday, and step out to the Rindermarkt or Viktualienmarkt for space.

Via [Wolters World](#), [Chris and Sara](#), [Life With Rachel and Christian](#), [Our Travel Place](#), [Near From Home](#) | [Slow Travel Germany](#)

● Bike lanes everywhere

TAKE MOST CARE: ALWAYS

The most common warning from creators. Munich's cyclists are fast and bike lanes blend into the pavement, often in a slightly different colour. Look both ways before stepping off the kerb and keep children out of the red lanes.

Via [Wolters World](#), [Amy Zhong](#)

● The Eisbach in the Englischer Garten

TAKE MOST CARE: ANY TIME

Watch the river surfers from the bridge, but the water is fast and cold. Eva Meloche's group struggled to get out after swimming; keep children well back from the edge.

Via [Eva Meloche](#), [MY Travel BF](#)

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Walking back after the markets close? Save your hotel on Wiley Fox, stick to the lit main streets and keep SOS one tap away.

Scams and tricks creators keep seeing

Plain-clothes ticket inspectors

Not a scam: MVV inspectors ride in normal clothes and show ID on board. Tickets must be validated (stamped) as well as bought, or you pay €60. Apps validate automatically.

Via [Happy to Wander \(Travel Tips & Inspo\)](#), [Rok Goes Around](#), [Wolters World](#)

Pickpockets in the crowd

Munich police warn that thefts happen 'again and again' in Christmas-market crowds. Keep valuables in inner pockets, bags closed and in front, and be careful in queues; ring 110 if you see something.

Via [Deana and Phil](#)

Deposits on everything

Mugs carry a Pfand, usually €5 in 2025, and plates €1. The medieval market charges €10-15 for its clay goblets, so a €8 drink costs €23 up front - you get it back when you return it.

Via [Chris and Sara](#), [East-West Wander](#), [Wolters World](#)

Taxis from the airport

About Munich says taxi scams are almost non-existent, but €100 or more from the airport is normal. The S-Bahn (S1/S8) with an Airport-City-Day-Ticket is far cheaper.

Via [About Munich](#)

NEIGHBOURHOODS

Where to stay

Pick an area first, then a hotel. The old town is compact, so most bases are within a short walk of the markets.



Photo: Martin Falbisoner · CC BY-SA 3.0

Altstadt (around Marienplatz)

FIRST-TIMERS • CHRISTMAS MARKETS

The best base for a short trip: everything in the old town is 10-15 minutes' walk, and the Christmas market is on your doorstep. It's also the most expensive area - Travel Tips Group quotes about €150-200 a night for three stars and €250-300 for four (2025) - and it is packed around Marienplatz on December weekends.

Via [Travel Tips Group](#), [Happy to Wander \(Travel Tips & Inspo\)](#), [MissTourist](#), [Stefano Ferro](#)

Near the Hauptbahnhof (Ludwigsvorstadt)

BUDGET • ARRIVING BY TRAIN • DAY TRIPS

The cheapest hotels in the centre, 10 minutes' walk from the old town, with the airport S-Bahn and day-trip trains on the doorstep. Creators are split: Happy to Wander says you won't be in danger, while Stefano Ferro calls it the dodgiest, noisiest part of town and a local wouldn't live there with children. Police focus on the southern Bahnhofsviertel and the Alter Botanischer Garten, so choose a hotel on the north side or on the main road.

Via [Happy to Wander \(Travel Tips & Inspo\)](#), [Stefano Ferro](#), [German Insider](#), [Travel Tips Group](#), [Our Travel Place](#)

Lehel

FAMILIES • QUIET NIGHTS

Quiet, pretty and residential, between the old town and the Englischer Garten, and walkable to the Residenz and Marienplatz. Stefano Ferro recommends it for families; the catch is price and not much nightlife.



Photo: GFrehalter · CC BY-SA 3.0

Haidhausen

Via [Stefano Ferro](#), [Happy to Wander \(Travel Tips & Inspo\)](#)

FAMILIES • LOCAL FEEL

Across the Isar, quieter with a villagey feel, cafés and its own local Christmas market. A few minutes by S-Bahn from Marienplatz. Happy to Wander calls it a favourite and MissTourist says there's plenty for families.

Via [Happy to Wander \(Travel Tips & Inspo\)](#), [MissTourist](#), [Senior Travel World](#), [Near From Home](#) | [Slow Travel Germany](#)



Photo: Martin Falbisoner · CC BY-SA 4.0

Schwabing & Maxvorstadt

SOLO TRAVELLERS • MUSEUMS • COUPLES

The university and museum quarter north of the centre, running into leafy Schwabing by the Englischer Garten. Slightly cheaper, lively with cafés and student bars, and on the U3/U6 for the Schwabing and Chinese Tower markets.

Via [Travel Tips Group](#), [Rok Goes Around](#), [Senior Travel World](#), [MissTourist](#)



Photo: Photo: Andreas Praefcke · CC BY 3.0

Glockenbachviertel & Gärtnerplatz

SOLO TRAVELLERS • NIGHTLIFE

Trendy, LGBTQ+ friendly and lively at night, close to Pink Christmas and the Viktualienmarkt. A little cheaper than the Altstadt, but further from the S-Bahn and noisy at weekends.

Via [Happy to Wander \(Travel Tips & Inspo\)](#), [City Zen](#), [Stefano Ferro](#)

Hotels we'd start with

Wiley Fox may earn a small commission if you book through these links. Your price stays the same.

ALTSTADT (PROMENADEPLATZ) • LUXURY

Hotel Bayerischer Hof

SCHWABING • COUPLES & COMFORT

Andaz Munich Schwabinger Tor

Grand old-town hotel a few minutes from Marienplatz and the markets. Not creator-reviewed: a Wiley Fox pick for location.

€€€€ PRICE BAND

SEE PRICES

Wiley Fox pick

Five-star with a spa and rooftop pool; Oriana Findlay liked the café downstairs (2024). On the U6 to the centre.

€€€€ PRICE BAND

SEE PRICES

Via [Oriana Findlay](#)

NEAR THE HAUPTBAHNHOF • SOLO & BUDGET

Euro Youth Hostel

A solo creator found it felt more like a hotel: very clean, dorms and private rooms, great breakfast and location (2024).

€ PRICE BAND

SEE PRICES

Via [Visha Khandelwal](#)

BOGENHAUSEN • FAMILIES WITH A CAR

Best Western Hotel Arabella Park

Where Is Briggs, with little children, found clean, spacious modern rooms, a big breakfast and parking (2025). Further out, on the U4.

€€ PRICE BAND

SEE PRICES

Via [Where Is Briggs](#)

Search all Munich hotels

Compare live prices, then check the street on the Wiley Fox map before you book.

SEARCH BOOKING.COM

WF

Clip a Wiley Fox QR wristband on each child. If you get separated in the Marienplatz crowd, anyone who scans it can contact you straight away - no app needed on their side.

WHAT CREATORS RATE

Ten things worth your time

Ranked by how often creators recommend them. Most are within a 15-minute walk of Marienplatz; in December, see the sights by daylight and save the markets for the evening.

01



Photo: Strubbl · CC BY-SA 4.0

Marienplatz & the Glockenspiel

ALTSTADT • GREAT FOR KIDS

The main square under the neo-Gothic Neues Rathaus. Its Glockenspiel plays at 11:00 and 12:00 in winter - some creators call it underwhelming, but children love it. The Rathaus tower has a lift to a viewing platform, and the courtyard is free.

Via [Rob on Holiday](#), [Adventures of Matt and Nat](#), [Wolters World](#), [MY Travel BF](#), [Where Is Briggs](#), [Amy Zhong](#), [Chip Hammontree](#)

Free

DETAILS

02



Photo: High Contrast · CC BY 3.0 de

St Peter's tower (Alter Peter)

ALTSTADT • GREAT FOR KIDS

306 steps up a narrow two-way stair for the best view of the Christmas market and, on clear days, the Alps. The Little Basket suggests going just before sunset. A squeeze with small children. Closes at 14:00 on 24 and 31 December.

Via [Here's Good](#), [thelittlebasket](#), [Adventures of A+K](#), [Johlene Orton](#), [Max and Sidney](#), [Rok Goes Around](#)

€5 · 6-18 €2 · under 6 free (2026)

DETAILS

03



Viktualienmarkt

ALTSTADT • GREAT FOR KIDS

Munich's food market since 1807, with about 140 stalls, a beer garden and extra Christmas chalets in December. Much calmer than Marienplatz; a Leberkäse or Krustenbraten roll is €3-5, and there are free water fountains. Closed Sundays and holidays.

Via [Here's Good](#), [Sophie Nadeau](#), [Fatih Anlatiyor](#), [Locavore Eats](#), [MY Travel BF](#), [A Sense of Travel with Michael Matheny](#), [Chris and Sara](#)

Free to browse

DETAILS

04



Englischer Garten & the Eisbach surfers

ENGLISCHER GARTEN • GREAT FOR KIDS

A huge city park with river surfers riding a standing wave by the Haus der Kunst - the wave was reopened in May 2026 - and the Chinese Tower, which hosts a woodland Christmas market. In winter most beer gardens are shut.

Via [MY Travel BF](#), [Bayern Reisetipps](#) | [Reiseeuphorie](#), [Oriana Findlay](#), [Kai Travel](#), [Vacay In 1 Day](#), [Adventures of Matt and Nat](#)

Free

DETAILS

05



Photo: Wilfredor · CC0

Residenz

ALTSTADT · GREAT FOR KIDS

The Bavarian royal palace: 130 rooms and the Antiquarium hall, with a free audio guide; allow 2-3 hours. Big bags go in the free cloakroom. The queue at the main desk can be long at weekends - Valeska bought the same ticket at the Cuvilliés Theatre instead. Closed 24, 25 and 31 Dec and 1 Jan.

Via [Rob on Holiday](#), [Jm Banquicio](#), [Rok Goes Around](#), [valeska](#), [Our Travel Place](#), [Johlene Orton](#)

€10 · with treasury €15 · under 18 free (2026)

DETAILS

06

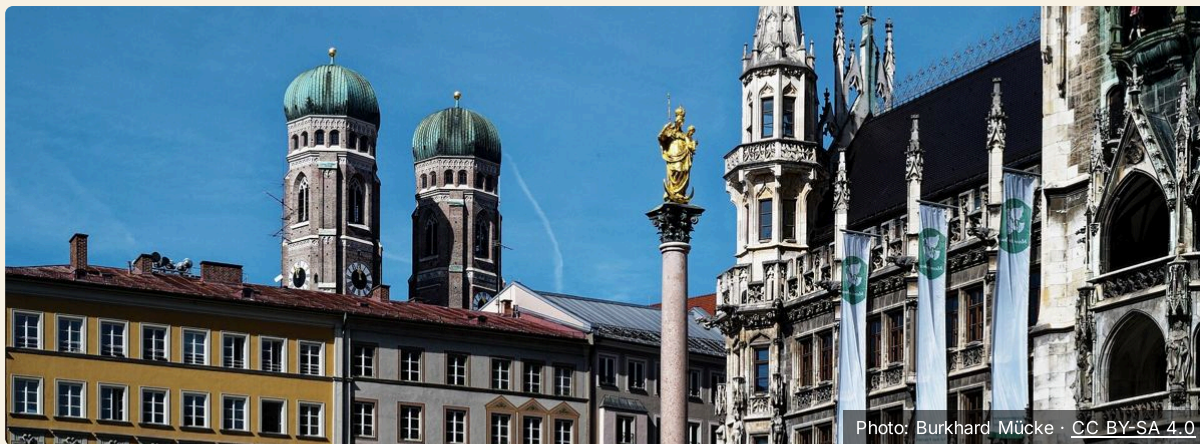


Photo: Burkhard Mücke · CC BY-SA 4.0

Frauenkirche

ALTSTADT · GREAT FOR KIDS

The twin-domed cathedral, free to enter and fairly plain inside. The south tower has 89 steps and then a lift, the easiest high viewpoint in the old town.

Via [Rob on Holiday](#), [Noah Anderson](#), [Rok Goes Around](#)

Church free · tower from €7.50 (2026)

DETAILS

07



Photo: Julian Herzog (Website) · CC BY 4.0

Deutsches Museum

MUSEUM ISLAND, ISARVORSTADT · GREAT FOR KIDS

One of the world's biggest science and technology museums, full of interactive exhibits - the best wet-day option for families. Closed 24-25 Dec and 31 Dec-1 Jan.

Via [Amy Zhong](#), [Alice & Lucas Travel](#)

€16 · 6-17 €9 · family €33 (2026)

DETAILS

08

Photo: Richard Bartz, Munich aka Makro Freak · [CC BY-SA 2.5](#)

Schloss Nymphenburg

NEUHAUSEN-NYMPHENBURG · GREAT FOR KIDS

The summer palace and its huge free park, 15-20 minutes on tram 17 from the Hauptbahnhof. Allow half a day.

Via [Rob on Holiday](#), [Our Travel Place](#), [A Sense of Travel with Michael Matheny](#), [Rok Goes Around](#)

Palace about €10 · gardens free (2025)

[DETAILS](#)

09

Hofbräuhaus

ALTSTADT

The famous beer hall: touristy, loud and chaotic, with a painted ceiling, brass band and litre glasses. Over 1,000 seats, so you'll usually find a place on the communal benches. Oriana Findlay found it fine alone; don't try to take a stein home.

Via [MY Travel BF](#), [HikinukiWorldTour](#), [Oriana Findlay](#), [Naick & Kim](#), [Wolters World](#), [Mathers On The Map](#)

Litre of beer about €10 (2025)

[DETAILS](#)

10

Tierpark Hellabrunn

THALKIRCHEN · GREAT FOR KIDS

Munich's zoo, by the Isar, with plenty for children and restaurants on site - worth it on a dry winter day if you wrap up.

Via [German Insider](#)

€24 · child €10 (from 1 Oct 2026)

[DETAILS](#)

If you only have one day

ONE

1

The classic loop

09:00	Viktualienmarkt breakfast. Weisswurst and a pretzel, or a Schmalznudel at Café Frischhut.
10:00	Christkindlmarkt at opening. Marienplatz and the Kripperlmarkt nativity stalls before the crowds.
11:00	Glockenspiel & Alter Peter. Watch the 11:00 show from the edge of the square, then climb the tower.
12:30	Lunch. A Bavarian lunch deal at Augustiner Klosterwirt or the Viktualienmarkt.
14:00	Residenz Christmas village. The fairy-tale forest and puppet shows in the palace courtyard, then the medieval market next door.
16:00	Rindermarkt & Sendlinger Tor. The quieter end of the market as the lights come on (sunset about 16:20).
18:30	Dinner. Pink Christmas for a drink, or dumplings at Wirtshaus in der Au.

Three days, grouped by area

DAY

1

Old town

AM	Viktualienmarkt and the Christkindlmarkt at opening.
PM	Alter Peter, the Frauenkirche and the Residenz.
EVE	Medieval market after dark and dinner in a beer hall.

DAY

2

Families & museums

AM	Deutsches Museum (or the zoo on a dry day).
PM	Residenz Christmas village and the Eiszauber rink at Karlsplatz.
EVE	Tollwood on the Theresienwiese - big covered tents if it rains.

DAY

3

Parks & neighbourhoods

AM	Englischer Garten: the Eisbach surfers and the Chinese Tower market.
PM	Schwabing market or Nymphenburg by tram 17.
EVE	Haidhausen market and dinner at the Hofbräukeller - or a day trip to Nuremberg or Salzburg instead.

WEISSWURST, SCHMALZNUDEL AND A MASS

Where to eat

Munich eats big: pork knuckle and dumplings in beer halls, Weisswurst before noon, and fried dough for breakfast. Every place is credited to the creator who recommended it, and prices carry the year.

Café Frischhut

BY THE VIKTUALIENMARKT • SCHMALZNUDEL CAFÉ

€

Tiny café that only fries Schmalznudel - warm, crisp sugared dough, €3.20 each (2025). Cash only; the queue was out of the door on a Monday late morning.

Family friendly

Via [MY Travel BF](#), [Chris and Sara](#), [Holoholo Travelers](#), [Locavore Eats](#), [Adventures of Matt and Nat](#)

VISIT

Viktualienmarkt stalls

ALTSTADT • MARKET FOOD

€

Weisswurst with sweet mustard and a pretzel (before noon - peel the skin), Leberkäse rolls and soup in winter, €3-5 a snack (2025).

Family friendly

Via [A Sense of Travel with Michael Matheny](#), [Chris and Sara](#), [DW Travel](#), [Oriana Findlay](#)

VISIT

Schneider Bräuhaus

ALTSTADT • BEER HALL

€€

Classic wheat-beer hall for a Weisswurst breakfast; Mathers On The Map preferred it to the Hofbräuhaus with their children.

Family friendly

Via [Locavore Eats](#), [Mathers On The Map](#)

VISIT

Augustiner Klosterwirt

BY THE FRAUENKIRCHE • BAVARIAN

€€

Lively inn opposite the Frauenkirche: a pork knuckle big enough for two or three, and Schweinebraten with dumplings. Expect a queue.

Family friendly

Via [Adventures of Matt and Nat](#), [HikinukiWorldTour](#)

VISIT

Andechser am Markt

VIKTUALIENMARKT • BAVARIAN

€€

Very busy and loud with a wait for a table, but huge portions and a praised schnitzel (2026).

Family friendly

Via [HikinukiWorldTour](#)

VISIT

Wirtshaus in der Au

AU • BAVARIAN

€€

Across the Isar, known for its dumplings and roast duck. Popular - book ahead.

Family friendly

Via [Our Travel Place](#), [Locavore Eats](#)

VISIT

Atzinger

MAXVORSTADT • STUDENT INN

€

Less touristy local inn; a schnitzel lunch was €10 in 2025, and lunch deals are common across Munich.

Family friendly

Via [Naick & Kim](#)

VISIT

Augustiner-Keller

NEAR THE HAUPTBAHNHOF • BEER CELLAR

€€

Huge beer hall and garden; Haxe and a litre of beer came to €26.50 in 2025.

Family friendly

Via [Kai Travel](#)

VISIT

Café Kaiserschmarrn

ALTSTADT • CAFÉ

€€

Kaiserschmarrn - torn, sugared pancake - to share, some of it served in cosy cable-car-style huts.

Family friendly

Via [Johlene Orton](#), [The Urban Jungle](#)

VISIT

Dallmayr

BY MARIENPLATZ • DELICATESSEN

€€€

Munich's grand food hall. Johlene Orton's Christmas set lunch in the café-bistro was €35 (2025).

Grown-ups

Via [Oriana Findlay](#), [Johlene Orton](#)

VISIT

Hofbräukeller

HAIDHAUSEN (WIENER PLATZ) • BEER HALL

€€

Far more local than the Hofbräuhaus; Near From Home's favourite, with pork Haxe and dumplings.

Family friendly

Via [Near From Home](#) | [Slow Travel Germany](#), [The Urban Jungle](#)

VISIT

Bodhi

NEAR THERESIENWIESE • VEGAN BAVARIAN

€€

Relaxed vegan restaurant with vegan Käsespätzle and schnitzel - handy before Tollwood.

Family friendly

Via [The Urban Jungle](#)

For a grown-ups' night: a Mass (a full litre) at the Hofbräuhaus for the spectacle, then somewhere more local - Schneider Bräuhaus, the Augustiner halls or the Hofbräukeller across the river. Beer-hall beer is strong, so pace yourself. Glockenbach and Gärtnerplatz are the bar districts, and Pink Christmas has a DJ until 10pm. Spirits need ID: the drinking age is 16 for beer and wine and 18 for spirits. Opening times and menus change, so check before you travel. Wiley Fox is not paid for restaurant listings.

BEFORE YOU GO

Getting around Munich

From the airport

The S1 and S8 run alternately, about every 10 minutes between them, taking around 40 minutes to the Hauptbahnhof (a bit less to Marienplatz on the S8). The Airport-City-Day-Ticket is €17.50 for one or €32.60 for a group of up to five (2026) and covers the rest of the day in the city. Don't board the occasional regional train to Regensburg. The Lufthansa Express bus is €13.

Via [About Munich](#), [Rob on Holiday](#)

Tickets and fines

A Zone M single is €4.20, a day ticket €10.10 and a group day ticket for up to five €19.70 (2026); day tickets run to 6am the next morning. Stamp paper tickets before you travel - there are no barriers, inspectors wear normal clothes, and the fine is €60. MVV Swipe in the MVGO app works out the cheapest fare for you. Zone M day tickets rise to €10.80 on 1 January 2027.

Via [Rob on Holiday](#), [Happy to Wander \(Travel Tips & Inspo\)](#), [About Munich](#), [Anisha K G](#)

Walking the markets

The main market runs through the pedestrian zone from Karlsplatz to Marienplatz and the Rindermarkt; the Residenz and medieval markets are 5-10 minutes north. Take the U3/U6 to Universität for the Chinese Tower or Münchner Freiheit for Schwabing, and U4/U5 to Theresienwiese for Tollwood.

Via [Happy to Wander \(Travel Tips & Inspo\)](#), [Near From Home](#) | [Slow Travel Germany](#), [Life With Rachel and Christian](#)

Night travel

Public transport runs roughly 4am to 1am, with U-Bahn trains all night on Fridays, Saturdays and before holidays and night trams from about 1:30am (Rok Goes Around, 2023).

Via [Rok Goes Around](#)

Day trips by train

The Bayern-Ticket (€34 for one, €44 for two, up to five people plus children) covers regional trains across Bavaria for a day. Nuremberg's market is about an hour by ICE, Salzburg about 1h30-1h40. For Neuschwanstein, book the timed castle tour online (€21 + €2.50 fee): in winter the

Marienbrücke viewpoint is often closed, paths are icy and it's dark by about 4:20pm.

Via [Rob on Holiday](#), [Wolters World](#), [Travels of Sarah Fay](#), [Meghan Elise](#)

What it costs

Single ticket, Zone M (adult) / child 6-14

€4.20 / €2.00 (short trip €2.10)

Jan 2026 (Zone M single unchanged from 1 Jan 2027)

Day ticket, Zone M, 1 person

€10.10 (€10.80 from 1 Jan 2027)

Jan 2026

Group day ticket, Zone M, 2-5 people

€19.70

Jan 2026

Child day ticket (6-14)

€3.80

Jan 2026

Airport-City-Day-Ticket (zones M-5), 1 person / group of 2-5

€17.50 / €32.60

Jan 2026

Deutschlandticket (monthly)

€63 (2027 price not final; ADAC projects €66.80)

2026

Alter Peter tower (adult / age 6-18 / under 6)

€5 / €2 / free

Sept 2026

Frauenkirche south tower, adult

from €7.50

Sept 2026

Residenz: museum / Schatzkammer / both

€10 / €10 / €15 (under 18 free)

2026

Deutsches Museum, adult / 6-17 / family

€16 / €9 / €33

Sept 2026 (start date not stated on page)

Olympiaturm

Closed for renovation; reopening expected Q1 2027 (old price €5.50 adult)

Sept 2026

Tierpark Hellabrunn, adult / child 4-14 (from 1 Oct 2026)

€24 / €10 (was €21 / €9 to 30 Sept)

Oct 2026

Bayern-Ticket, 1 person / 2 people

€34 / €44 (up to 5 people)

2026

Neuschwanstein ticket, adult (+ online fee)

€21 (+€2.50 per ticket online)

Münchner Eiszauber skating

NOT VERIFIED - no price found on official pages

Sept 2026

Left luggage locker, Hauptbahnhof

from €2 (6 hours) / €4 (24 hours)

2026

Toilet, Hauptbahnhof (rail&fresh)

€1.50

Sept 2025

Glühwein, Marienplatz market (up to)

€7.50 (range across markets €3.50-€7.50)

Dec 2025

Glühwein mug deposit (most stalls)

€5

Dec 2025

Fare-dodging fee (erhöhtes
Beförderungsentgelt)**€60 (€7 if you had a valid personal ticket and show it
in 14 days)**

2026

Creator prices carry the video date. Anything older than 18 months is marked to check.

Quick tips

Sights by day, markets by night

In December it's dark by about 4:20pm. Do the towers, museums and park first and save the markets for when the lights come on.

Pack for real cold

Creators saw freezing rain, 44 cm of snow and feels-like temperatures of -16°C in early December. Market stalls have no heaters - layers, gloves and grippy shoes.

Book dinner

Restaurants were booked out even on a December Wednesday. Reserve for evenings, or make lunch your main meal - many places have cheaper lunch menus.

Sundays and holidays

Shops close on Sundays and on 25, 26 December and 1 January; the Viktualienmarkt is closed Sundays and holidays. The markets and museums stay open on Sundays (state museums are €1 on Sundays, most closed on Mondays).

Plan for Christmas itself

Most markets end on 20-23 December. Only Marienplatz and Schwabing open on 24 December, until 14:00. The Residenz, Deutsches Museum and Neuschwanstein are closed on 24-25 December.

Keep out of the bike lanes

Munich's cyclists are fast and the lanes blend into the pavement. Look both ways before stepping off the kerb, especially with children.

WF

Found a cash-only stall, a closed tower or a street that felt wrong? Drop a community report on the map - it helps the next family.

THE SMALL THINGS VISITORS WORRY ABOUT

Local tips for Munich

Every tip here was checked against an official or trusted source (MVV, Munich police, muenchen.de, Deutsche Bahn, gov.uk and others) on the date shown. Rules and prices change, so tap the link to double-check before you travel.

Paying for transport

How much is a single ticket in central Munich?

From 1 Jan 2026 a single ticket for Zone M (the city area) is 4.20 euros. A short trip of up to 4 stops is 2.10 euros (2 stops on S-Bahn or U-Bahn). A child aged 6 to 14 pays 2.00 euros. Prices rise for some tickets on 1 Jan 2027, but Zone M single stays 4.20 euros. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

What is the best day ticket for a family?

The Zone M day ticket is 10.10 euros for one person. The group day ticket for 2 to 5 people is 19.70 euros. Both run until 6:00 the next morning. A child day ticket (6 to 14) is 3.80 euros. Since Jan 2026 children aged 6 to 14 travel free on the single day ticket: your own children, plus up to 3 other children. From 1 Jan 2027 the single Zone M day ticket goes up to 10.80 euros.

[Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Do young children need a ticket?

Children 6 to 14 need a child fare (single 2.00 euros, valid all zones for 5 hours). NOT VERIFIED on the pages I read: that under-6s travel free, which is the usual MVV rule. Check the MVV site before you publish it.

[Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Is the Deutschlandticket worth it for a short trip?

It costs 63 euros a month in 2026,. For a few days a day ticket is cheaper. The 2027 price was due to be fixed by late Sept 2026. ADAC reports 66.80 euros as a projection, not final. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

How do I validate a paper ticket, and what if I forget?

Stamp a paper single or day ticket in a validator before you travel. Bus and tram

How do I get from Munich Airport to the city centre?

Take the S1 or S8. They run alternately, every 10 minutes between them, and take

tickets are already validated. Riding without a valid ticket costs 60 euros. If you own a valid personal ticket but cannot show it, the fee drops to 7 euros with proof within 14 days. It is a civil fee, and an ordinary tourist error still counts. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

about 40 minutes to the Hauptbahnhof. The Airport-City-Day-Ticket (zones M to 5) is 17.50 euros for one person and 32.60 euros for 2 to 5 people from 1 Jan 2026. It is valid until 6:00 the next day on the whole network. Buy at airport machines.

[Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Where can I leave my luggage at the Hauptbahnhof?

DB lockers, open 24 hours, from 2 euros for 6 hours or 4 euros for 24 hours, paid in coins. Space can be limited because of the station building works. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Can we do Neuschwanstein as a day trip in winter?

Yes, but it is a long day. Adult ticket 21 euros plus a 2.50 euro booking fee online (2026). Entry is by guided tour at a fixed time. Booking online in advance is recommended as tickets sell out, though limited same-day tickets exist. From 16 Oct 2026 it opens 10:00-16:00 daily, closed 24, 25, 31 Dec and 1 Jan. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Is the Bayern-Ticket good for a day trip?

It costs 34 euros for one person, 44 euros for two, and covers up to 5 people plus up to 3 children aged 6 to 14 free. Valid on regional trains in Bavaria Mon-Fri from 9:00 and all day at weekends and holidays. The full 5-person price was not shown on the page I read. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Water & snacks

Is the tap water safe to drink?

Yes. Stadtwerke München (SWM) calls its M-Wasser 'a drinking water with excellent quality' and says you can simply help yourself at the tap. It comes from the

What is the bottle deposit thing on drinks?

Most plastic bottles and cans carry a 25 cent Pfand. Return them to the machine in

Bavarian foothills. Fill your bottle at the hotel tap. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

any shop that sells drinks and keep the receipt for the till. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

CHRISTMAS *Do I pay extra for my Glühwein mug?*

Yes. In Dec 2025 most Munich market stalls charged a 5 euro mug deposit (Pfand), per t-online. Stalls generally tolerate you keeping the mug as a souvenir. Glühwein at the Marienplatz market cost up to 7.50 euros in 2025. 2026 prices are not out, so check at the stall. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Toilets

Are there toilets at the Hauptbahnhof?

Yes. The rail&fresh toilets cost 1.50 euros (Sept 2025 report; check the price). Free options include the Marienplatz Prunkhof, U-Bahn Theresienwiese and Nußbaumpark. Some U-Bahn and Marienplatz mezzanine toilets cost 0.60 euros. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

CHRISTMAS *Are there toilets at the Marienplatz Christmas market?*

Yes. The organiser lists a barrier-free toilet in the Rathaus Prunkhof (euro key needed) and one in the Marienplatz U/S-Bahn station. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Parks & play

What is there to do with kids on a wet day?

Deutsches Museum: 16 euros adult, 9 euros ages 6 to 17, under 6 free, family ticket 33 euros. Open daily 9:00-17:00 but closed 24 and 25 Dec, and 31 Dec to 1 Jan. Ticket page does not give a start date for these prices. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Is Tierpark Hellabrunn worth it in winter?

Yes if wrapped up. From 1 Oct 2026 tickets are 24 euros adult, 10 euros child (4 to 14), with a 1 euro conservation contribution included (can be dropped). Small family 29 euros, large family 52 euros (read from the page's second price table). Winter 2025/26 hours were 9:00-17:00, 9:00-16:00 on 24

and 31 Dec. 2026/27 hours are NOT
VERIFIED. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Can I watch the Eisbach surfers?

Yes, this is back. The city reopened the Eisbachwelle for surfing on 8 May 2026 for experienced surfers, with a self-releasing leash and no surfing after 22:00. The wave had vanished in autumn 2025 and re-formed (press). Watch from a distance and do not swim. Conditions can change, so check before you go. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Money & tipping

CHRISTMAS ***Do the Christmas market stalls take cards?***

Mostly, at Marienplatz. The organiser says 80 per cent of stalls take cards, but some only above a 1, 5 or 10 euro minimum. Carry some cash for small buys and for toilets.

[Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

How much should I tip?

Around 5 to 10 percent in restaurants, or just round up. Tell the server the total when you pay. Taxis are usually rounded up or 10 percent. Tipping is voluntary, even if the card machine suggests amounts.

[Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Phones & data

Will my UK phone roam for free in Germany?

Not automatically. UK networks are not required to offer free EU roaming, so check your plan or buy a roaming pass before you fly. Ofcom lists local or virtual SIMs as another way to cut costs.

[Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Safety habits

What number do I ring in an emergency?

110 is police, and the police repeat it in their Christmas-market advice. 112 is fire and ambulance (not re-checked on a Munich page this session). For an urgent illness out of hours, call the doctor on-call service on 116 117. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

How do I find an emergency pharmacy?

Pharmacies take turns at night and on holidays. Search by postcode on [aponet.de](#). It says results are not binding because duties change at short notice, so phone first if you can. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

What if I lose something in Munich?

City lost property (Fundbüro), Implersstraße 11, works by online appointment: phone +49 89 233-96045. Items are kept 6 months. For U-Bahn, bus and tram, use the MVG Fundbüro (Elsenheimerstraße 61) or its online loss report. For S-Bahn, use the Deutsche Bahn lost property.

[Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

How safe is Munich, and where should I be careful?

Police say the city's crime rate in 2025 was 5,798 offences per 100,000 residents, 2.7% lower than 2024 and far below Berlin (13,233) or Cologne (12,387).

Pickpocketing in the wider police area fell 10.6% to 1,489. Take care around the Hauptbahnhof and southern Bahnhofsviertel, where police still report street drinkers, begging and drug scene. Violent crime across the area rose 2.0% to a ten-year high, though street robbery fell 58.9%. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

CHRISTMAS ***How do I avoid pickpockets at the Christmas markets?***

Munich police warn of pickpockets in crowds and queues. Keep valuables in inner pockets close to the body, carry bags closed and in front of you, and be careful in queues. Ring 110 if you see something. Plain-clothes pickpocket squads work the markets. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Are knives allowed in the city centre?

Not in some places. A permanent knife and weapon ban zone covers the Alter Botanischer Garten and Karl-Stützel-Platz, all day, from 15 Jan 2025 (first for two years). Police also say weapons and knives are banned on Christmas markets. At the Hauptbahnhof the federal police only impose short temporary bans, so check the notices. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Can I drink alcohol on the street near the Hauptbahnhof?

No. A city ban forbids drinking, or carrying alcohol meant for drinking, on public land around the station (Bahnhofplatz, Arnulfstraße, Bayerstraße from no. 24, Schützenstraße and nearby). It runs to 1 May 2028 and was amended in Feb 2026. Licensed terraces and station buildings are excluded. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

CHRISTMAS *Can I set off fireworks on New Year's Eve?*

Not in the centre. Last year (2025/26) fireworks were banned in the pedestrian zone from Marienplatz to Karlsplatz and at Viktualienmarkt from 21:00 to 02:00. Bangers were banned all day inside the Mittlerer Ring, and around the zoo. Sparklers were allowed. The 2026/27 rules are NOT announced yet, so recheck in December. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

CHRISTMAS *What was New Year's Eve like in the centre last year?*

Press reports of the police balance: over 610 operations overnight, about 6,000 people at Marienplatz at midnight and the night was 'largely peaceful'. A rocket was fired into a crowd at Friedensengel. Figures are from press, not a police release I could read. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

Local ways

Are shops open on Sundays and holidays?

No. Shops may open Mon-Sat 6:00-20:00 and must close on Sundays and public holidays. In 2026 that means Sunday 20 and 27 Dec, Friday 25 and Saturday 26 Dec, and Friday 1 Jan 2027. 24 and 31 Dec are not legal holidays, so ordinary shops may open, but many close early. NOT VERIFIED: any legal closing time on 24 Dec. Small shops at stations can sell travel needs on Sundays. Bakeries may sell 8:00-11:00 on Sundays. Older IHK text says Bavaria

Is 8 December a public holiday in Munich?

No. 8 December (Immaculate Conception) is not a public holiday in Bavaria. It is a Tuesday in 2026, so shops are open as usual. [Checked 2026-09 ↗](#)

has no own shop law, but the city says a new Bavarian law applies from 1 Aug 2025.

Checked 2026-09 ↗

When are the public holidays over Christmas and New Year?

25 Dec (Fri), 26 Dec (Sat), 1 Jan 2027 (Fri) and 6 Jan 2027 (Wed, Epiphany) are public holidays in Bavaria. Christmas Eve and New Year's Eve are not legal days off, but many places shut early. Checked 2026-09 ↗

What are the Glockenspiel times in winter?

The Rathaus Glockenspiel plays daily at 11:00 and 12:00 in winter. The extra 17:00 show is March to October only. The night watchman blows his horn at 21:00.

Checked 2026-09 ↗

Can we climb the Frauenkirche tower?

Yes, the south tower. Tickets start at 7.50 euros for adults. There are 89 steps, then a lift. Winter hours Mon-Sat 10:00-17:00, Sun and holidays 11:30-17:00. On 24 Dec 2026 it closes from 14:00, on 31 Dec from 16:00, and on 1 Jan 2027 it is closed.

Checked 2026-09 ↗

Can we climb Alter Peter?

Yes. 5 euros adults, 2 euros ages 6 to 18, under 6 free, and 306 steps. Winter hours Mon-Fri 9:00-18:30, Sat, Sun and holidays 9:00-19:30. On 24 Dec and 31 Dec 2026 it shuts at 14:00. It is closed 25 Dec and 1 Jan. You cannot book ahead.

Checked 2026-09 ↗

Is the Residenz open over Christmas?

Open daily 10:00-17:00 in winter (last entry 16:00), but closed 24, 25 and 31 Dec and 1 Jan. Residenzmuseum 10 euros, Schatzkammer 10 euros, both 15 euros. Under 18s go free. Checked 2026-09 ↗

Can we go up the Olympiaturm?

Not at Christmas 2026. The tower has been shut for renovation since 1 June 2024 and is expected to reopen in Q1 2027. Do not put it in the guide as open. Checked 2026-09 ↗

What are the passport and entry rules for UK visitors?

Gov.uk says your passport must be under 10 years old on arrival and valid for at least 3 months after you leave the Schengen area. You can visit visa-free for up to 90

days in any 180. The EU Entry/Exit System (EES) is being rolled out: you may give fingerprints and a photo on first entry (children 11 and under give a photo only). Allow extra time. The page does not mention ETIAS. It also notes temporary controls at Germany's land borders.

Checked 2026-09 ↗

Travel with Wiley Fox

Official travel advice for 200+ countries, community reports, one-tap SOS, and QR wristbands so lost children and lost bags find their way back.

Our sources

This guide summarises these creators' videos in our own words. Watch the originals - they are worth it. Crime data: Polizeipräsidium München, Sicherheitsreport 2025 (Jan 2025 to Dec 2025). City and police-area statistics for 2025 (published 20 March 2026), Munich police statements on the Christmas markets (November 2025), the City of Munich's knife-ban and alcohol-ban rules for the station area, and the city's New Year's Eve firework rules for 2025/26. No street-level data is published, and rates are per resident, not adjusted for visitors.

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